PRODUCT VISION • STANDALONE PRODUCT • OCTOBER 2026 • REVISED 29 OCTOBER 2026

Family Tithi Loop

Every occasion a family celebrates or remembers - shraddhas, birthdays, anniversaries, the festivals and vrats it chooses, life milestones - entered once, and reminded every year on WhatsApp to everyone who should know, in their own language, in time to prepare. Tithi dates are worked out correctly for the family's home and tradition. A standalone product, launching with MyDharohar as partner. The pilot runs in Marathi, Hindi and English; further languages follow as reviewed content packs once families have shown they will pay.



Verdict

Pursue with changes - ranked #1 overall in market research across seven ideas.

Price to test

Rs 599 per year per family - about Rs 50 a month. A proposal to validate, not a forecast.

First step

A paid concierge pilot with 30 families in Marathi, Hindi and English, from November 2026. No engine is built until it passes.

This document covers Family Tithi Loop only. It implements the six changes required by the research verdict, revised so that the product is standalone from day one - its own brand, app and web, sign-up, billing, WhatsApp number and audience - with MyDharohar as launch partner and a possible future bundle. This revision also widens scope to all family occasions (tithi-aware), stages language content behind the pilot, starts the pilot now (Pitru Paksha 2026 has passed) and adds a section on why families will pay. All competitor prices are research findings from October 2026; all proposed prices are tests to validate. MyDharohar live site: https://www.mydharohar.org/

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The original idea was another calendar. The changed idea is a family occasions loop - tithi-aware.

There is no shortage of panchang or reminder apps. There is a shortage of anyone who remembers, for a specific family, that a father's shraddha falls on a particular tithi, that Aaji's birthday is kept by tithi while a grandson's is by date, that this family keeps Sankashti and Bhau-beej but not Karva Chauth - works out which Gregorian date each falls on this year, and tells the whole family in time.

Family Tithi Loop does that one job, as a standalone product. A configurator - often an adult child - enters the family's occasions once: ancestors' shraddhas, birthdays and anniversaries (by tithi or by date), the festivals, vrats and kuldevta days this family chooses, life milestones and custom dates. The system computes each year's date - tithi dates shift every year - and sends WhatsApp reminders, each in the recipient's own language, to every member who wants them, with a short practical note. No one else needs to install anything, which matters most for elders.

> **The answer to "what changes are you proposing?" in one line:** do not build a panchang app - build only the family's own occasions loop, tithi-aware, deliver it on WhatsApp, launch it as a standalone product with MyDharohar as launch partner, make date correctness a reviewed trust system, price it per family, and prove willingness to pay with a paid manual pilot before writing the engine.

What success looks like in the first year

- A pilot in which at least 15 of 30 families pay Rs 299 for a season, and at least 10 say they would pay Rs 599 per year.
- Zero wrong-date incidents in the pilot, with every date checked against a reviewed source.
- A small, trusted family record that families keep up because it spares them a recurring worry - not because of streaks, fear or astrology upsells.

What this revision changes

- **Standalone from day one,** with MyDharohar as launch partner (cross-promotion, shared content, early families) and a combined plan as a later phase (pages 14-15).
- **All family occasions, tithi-aware.** Tithi correctness and the WhatsApp family loop stay the paid differentiator; festivals appear only if the family chose them (pages 5, 16).
- **Language content is staged; the pilot starts now** in two stages and stays paid (pages 10, 22). **A sharper paid offer,** with a free trial tested at launch (pages 19-21).

A note on the name: "Family Tithi Loop" is kept for now. With the wider scope it may undersell birthdays, anniversaries and festivals; it is worth reconsidering before any brand work, ideally keeping the tithi promise visible.

THE PROPOSED CHANGES

Six changes turn a crowded calendar idea into a defensible product

1

Not a panchang app - the family's own occasions, tithi-aware

Never compete on daily panchang data - free and commoditised. The product is only the occasions this family celebrates or remembers, with tithi dates computed correctly as the hero. Calendar-date birthdays, anniversaries and custom dates are a convenience so the family has one place for its dates; festivals appear only if the family chose them. If a feature is generic calendar data, it is out of scope.

2

WhatsApp-first, app optional

Reminders arrive where the family already is. The configurator may use a simple app or web form; recipients - above all elders - need no install, no login and no new habit. Language is a system built in the MVP, not a single language (page 10). Pilot content is in Marathi, Hindi and English; every member in their own language.

3

Standalone product, MyDharohar as launch partner

Its own brand, app and web, sign-up, billing, WhatsApp number and audience from day one. MyDharohar is the launch partner: cross-promotion, licensed or shared festival and preparation content, and early families. A combined MyDharohar plan is a possible later bundle, not a dependency.

4

Correctness as trust

A proven ephemeris library plus a pandit-reviewed validation source, explicit handling of adhik maas, kshaya tithi and location, and a pre-send check on every shraddha date. One wrong shraddha date can end the product.

5

Family-plan pricing, honest upsells

Test Rs 599 per year per family, framed within Rs 499-Rs 999 per year - not per-user app pricing. Paid extras are cheap, calm and useful: an annual family-dates calendar, a priest-ready note, an exportable ancestor record. No fear-based astrology, ever.

6

Validate before building

Run a concierge pilot first: 30 families in three languages, Stage A from November 2026 and Stage B through Pitru Paksha 2027, dates computed semi-manually, reminders sent by hand. Build the engine only if the payment bars in this document are met.

Why the changes matter together: each change removes a specific reason the original idea would fail - commodity competition (1), elder non-adoption (2), cold-start acquisition cost (3 - now met through partner cross-promotion, referrals and diaspora and community channels, rather than a host product), trust-destroying errors (4), a Rs 0 price anchor (5), and building before anyone has paid (6). Dropping any one of them reopens that failure mode.

THE PROBLEM

Generic calendars answer "what is the date?" Nobody answers "what does our family need to remember?"

Every existing calendar assumes one person, looking up a generic date, for themselves, in the moment. Family ritual life does not work that way.

Four ways the current system fails

- **The knowledge is concentrated.** In many families one elder, one aunt, or the printed almanac on the kitchen wall holds the family's tithis. When that person is travelling, unwell or no longer there, dates are missed or reconstructed from memory.
- **The date moves.** A shraddha tithi does not fall on the same Gregorian date each year. Remembering "sometime in September" is not remembering. Someone must convert the tithi every year, correctly, for the family's location and tradition.
- **Discovery is too late.** Families often learn a date is near when there is no time left to arrange leave, travel, ingredients, a priest or a puja booking. A reminder on the day itself is a notification of failure, not help.
- **The loop is manual and fragile.** Today the loop is a family WhatsApp group plus whoever remembers. That depends on one person's memory and goodwill, and it quietly excludes members who are not in that group or not in the same city or country.

> **Evidence the missing layer is real:** online puja platforms that book shraddha and Pitru Paksha services must ask the customer to supply the tithi, or an approximate date, at booking. The businesses closest to the money do not hold the family's tithi record. Nobody does. That record - maintained once, converted correctly every year, and shared with the whole family - is the product.

Who feels this most

Adult children living away from their parents, including outside India, who carry responsibility for family observances but not the almanac knowledge; elders who observe vrats faithfully but should not need an app to be reminded of their own family's dates; and the family member who currently remembers for everyone and would gladly hand the job over.

PRODUCT DEFINITION

One setup, by one person, serves the whole family for years

Roles

Role	Who they are and what they do
Configurator	Usually an adult child. Signs up in the Tithi Loop app or web, enters the family's occasions once, invites members, chooses languages, pays the family plan. The only person who needs the app.
Knowledge holder	Often an elder or a family priest, consulted during setup to confirm tithis and family practice. Never required to use the product afterwards.
Recipients	Invited members in India or abroad. They receive WhatsApp reminders for the occasions they opted into, and can reply to pause, change language or opt out. No install.
Payer	Usually the configurator - sometimes a child abroad, or a child gifting the plan to parents. One payment covers the whole family.

What the family record contains - every occasion the family keeps

Occasion	Recurrence	Notes
Shraddha and death anniversaries	Tithi (or date, if the family keeps it by date)	Annual death-anniversary tithi and Pitru Paksha (Mahalaya) tithi stored separately; Gregorian date of passing as a cross-check.
Birthdays and anniversaries	Tithi or date	Birthdays kept by tithi, by date, or both; wedding anniversaries; first-year anniversaries.
Family festivals	Festival rule	Only the ones this family chooses - for example Diwali, Ganesh Chaturthi, Raksha Bandhan, Bhau-beej, Karva Chauth, Makar Sankranti. Never all of them.
Kuldevta and vrat days	Tithi rule	Ekadashi, Sankashti, Satyanarayan, a kuldevta day, a family-specific vrat.
Life milestones	Tithi or date	Munj/upanayan, naming ceremony, griha pravesh and their anniversaries.
Custom dates	Tithi or date	Anything else the family wants remembered.

Family preferences: home location for calculation; language and time zone per recipient; which occasions each member receives; lead time; a per-member frequency cap; and an optional quiet-season digest instead of individual messages for minor dates.

Positioning guardrail: tithi dates are the hero and the differentiator. Calendar-date birthdays, anniversaries and custom dates are a convenience that makes this the family's one place for its dates - they are not a reason to become a generic reminders app.

Explicitly not the product: daily panchang browsing, horoscopes, rashifal, muhurat shopping, astrology consultations, a festival encyclopaedia, or festival reminders the family did not choose.

HOW IT WORKS

Quiet for most of the year, useful exactly when it matters

1. Set up
Configurator adds each family date, helped by the knowledge holder. Unknown tithi? Setup offers a guided lookup from the Gregorian date of passing, flagged for confirmation.

2. Confirm
The family reviews a plain-language summary: "For Aaji, shraddha tithi is ..." One confirmation step, because errors entered here repeat every year.

3. Invite
Members join by a WhatsApp invite link. Each picks a language from those published - in the pilot, Marathi, Hindi or English - and can decline with no friction.

4. Remind
Days ahead, each member gets the occasions they opted into, with a short note - or a wish to forward, for a birthday or anniversary. A day-of note if wanted.

5. Prepare
The note covers what is done and what to keep ready - content licensed or shared from MyDharohar at launch - and optionally a puja-booking link.

Example reminder (illustrative wording)

> **Marathi / Hindi WhatsApp message, sent a few days ahead:** a greeting naming the observance and the ancestor or family member, the Gregorian date and weekday for this year, one line on what the family usually does, a short preparation list, and a link to the fuller note. No predictions, no warnings, no sales pressure. The exact lead time - proposed at 7 days and 2 days, plus an optional day-of note - is a setting to test in the pilot, not a fixed promise.

Design principles for recipients

- **Readable by an elder on a basic phone:** short lines, large clear structure, the date impossible to miss, no links required to get the essential information.
- **One message, complete:** the reminder must be useful even if the recipient never taps anything.
- **Respectful frequency:** only the occasions each member opted into, within a per-member weekly cap, with an optional digest for minor dates. Festivals only if the family chose them. Silence between occasions is a feature.
- **Clear for members abroad:** the date and weekday are the family's home-location date, labelled with that place, and the message arrives at a sensible hour where the recipient lives.
- **Easy exit:** replying to stop or pause works, and the configurator is told gently - not with an alarm - if a member opts out.

SCREENS AND FLOWS

Only the configurator sees screens. Everyone else sees a message.

Configurator flow (Family Tithi Loop app or web)

Screen	Purpose and key decisions
0. Sign up	Tithi Loop's own sign-up by phone number (WhatsApp OTP) or email. At launch, the free trial starts here, with a payment method collected (see page 18).
1. Family home	Family name, home place, tradition and convention, members, and the next upcoming family occasions at a glance.
2. Add an occasion	Choose the occasion type - shraddha, birthday, anniversary, festival, vrat/kuldevta day, milestone or custom. Then choose **tithi-based** (paksha, month, tithi - or a guided conversion from a date, marked "please confirm") or **calendar date**. Festivals are picked from a reviewed list - only the ones this family keeps.
3. Region and tradition	Family location, calendar convention (amanta or purnimanta, where relevant) and community practice. Only validated conventions can be chosen. This drives calculation and content.
4. Review and confirm	Plain-language read-back of every occasion with this year's computed date, for checking against a known source before anything is scheduled.
5. Members	Invite by WhatsApp. For each member: language, country and time zone, which occasions they receive (opt-in per occasion), lead time, frequency cap and quiet-season digest.
6. Plan and billing	Tithi Loop's own billing: one family plan, who pays (including a gift or a payer abroad), trial end and first-charge date, renewal, easy cancellation. A MyDharohar bundle may appear here later.

Recipient experience (WhatsApp only)

- Invite message in the recipient's language, naming who invited them and which occasions they will receive.
- Reminders with a preparation note; for a birthday or anniversary, a short wish the recipient can forward to the person being celebrated.
- Optional "today in our family" memories (for example "Today in 1998: griha pravesh of the Pune house"), only for occasions the family opted in.
- Simple replies: pause, change language, switch to digest, or stop. An annual family calendar the configurator can share.

> **Transliteration where it helps:** names of occasions, people and places render in the recipient's script, with transliteration where a family mixes scripts - never silently mangled or dropped.

A wrong shraddha date is not a bug. It is the end of trust.

Most software can survive a wrong date. This product cannot. A family that performs shraddha on the wrong day because the product said so will not file a bug report; they will leave, and they will tell others why. Correctness is therefore designed as a system, not a library call.

The calculation stack

- **Proven ephemeris, never hand-rolled astronomy:** build on a well-tested ephemeris / panchang calculation library with a public track record, pinned to a version, with its outputs regression-tested whenever it changes.
- **Location-based calculation:** tithi observance depends on local sunrise and place. The family's home location is a first-class input, stored per family, and used for every computation - never a single national default, and never the recipient's location by accident.
- **Regional conventions as explicit rules:** amanta and purnimanta month reckoning, regional month and new-year systems, and tradition-specific observance rules are modelled as named, testable conventions selected at setup - not buried assumptions from one region.

Edge cases that must be handled, named in advance

Case	Handling principle
Adhik maas (extra lunar month)	Apply the reviewed rule for the family's tradition for observances falling in an adhik month, show the family which rule was applied, and never silently shift a shraddha.
Kshaya tithi (skipped tithi) and vriddhi (repeated) tithi	Follow the tradition's observance rule tied to sunrise at the family location; surface the case to the configurator in plain language when it affects a family date.
Mahalaya shraddha in Pitru Paksha	Stored separately from the annual death-anniversary tithi. Default from the ancestor's tithi, with the family's own practice (for example Sarvapitri Amavasya) recorded as an override; rules confirmed with each convention's reviewer before Stage B.
Conflicting traditions within one family	One family record, one stated convention for calculation, chosen by the configurator with the knowledge holder. Where members follow different practice, note the difference in the record and send the family's chosen date with the note visible - do not send two competing dates as if both were settled.
Uncertain input tithi	Dates entered from memory or converted from a Gregorian date are marked unconfirmed until the family checks them against a trusted source or priest. Unconfirmed shraddha dates get an extra confirmation prompt before the first reminder cycle.

CORRECTNESS, CONTINUED

Every tradition gets its own validation source - not one region's rule for all India

- **Pandit-reviewed validation:** for each tradition and region onboarded, a named validation source - a reviewed published panchang for that region and convention, checked with a knowledgeable reviewer - is recorded. Sample family dates are computed and compared against that source before the region is opened to customers.
- **Golden test set:** a fixed set of dates across years, including adhik maas years, kshaya cases and Pitru Paksha, whose expected results are known. Every engine or library change must pass the full set before release.
- **Pre-send check for shraddha:** shraddha reminders get an additional check in the days before sending - computed date re-verified against the validation source for that family's convention. In the pilot this check is human; in the product it is automated plus sampled human review.
- **Transparent correction policy:** if an error is ever found, affected families are told directly, in their language, what was wrong and what the correct date is - before the observance where humanly possible. Hiding an error to protect the brand would destroy the trust the brand is built on.
- **Show your working, lightly:** each reminder can carry one quiet line naming the tithi and convention used, so a family priest or elder can verify it. Confidence comes from checkability, not from asserting accuracy.

MULTILINGUAL, PAN-INDIA BY DESIGN

Maharashtra is the starting point, not the ceiling

The research validated the idea in Maharashtra, in Marathi and Hindi, because that is where the launch partner MyDharohar's audience and assets are strongest. The vision in this document is pan-India: a family ritual record for families anywhere in India - and for family members living outside India who still follow the home tradition. Nothing in the core loop is Maharashtra-specific. What varies by region is language, calendar convention, names and customs - and the product is designed around that variation from the start, rather than translated into it later.

Design rule: language and region are a system, not a string file. Adding a language without its calendar convention, validation source and preparation content is not a launch; it is a liability. That is why the system is built once, in the MVP, and each language's content is added only when it has passed its own gate.

LANGUAGE AND REGION SYSTEM

Each member gets their own language. Each family keeps its own tradition.

The language system is MVP architecture. Language content is staged.

The system is built once, in the MVP, so that adding a language later is editorial work and does not need a rebuild. The content is not built all at once. The pilot runs in three languages because 30 families cannot validate eleven: spread across eleven languages, that would be about three families per language - too few to learn anything - and the full editorial cost would be paid before anyone had paid for the product.

Built in the MVP - for every language

- **Per-language storage:** every template, preparation note, tithi name and ritual term stored per language, never hard-coded.
- **Per-member language:** an elder in Pune can receive Marathi, a son in Delhi Hindi and a daughter in Toronto English - same observance, same record, same day.
- **Script and transliteration** as system features.
- **Reviewed-only publishing:** only content approved by a named native reviewer is sent. Unreviewed terms fall back to the reviewed term in the family's primary language plus transliteration - never unreviewed machine translation.
- **Convention as data:** amanta, purnimanta and tradition rules are named, testable rule sets on the family record, each with golden tests.
- **Gating flag:** a language or convention is published or unavailable; configurators only see what is published.

Staged - content added when earned

- **Pilot:** Marathi, Hindi, English content; amanta convention primary.
- **Optional pilot cohort:** about 5-6 Hindi-speaking purnimanta families, only if a reviewer and a validation source for purnimanta are named in time.
- **After the pass bars:** Gujarati, Bengali, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, Punjabi and Odia, one gated content pack at a time.
- **Later:** any further language (for example Assamese) through the same gate.

Pilot content set - decided: Marathi, Hindi and English, amanta primary, for Maharashtra-rooted families including members elsewhere in India and abroad. Each pilot language has a named native reviewer, and each convention a named validation source, before the first reminder is sent. No language ships with machine-translation-only content.

Why these three: the launch partner's audience and content are Marathi and Hindi, and English serves younger members and the diaspora. One primary convention keeps the 30 families concentrated enough for the results to mean something.

Editorial rule: templates and notes are drafted or reviewed by a native-speaking editor; machine translation may assist a draft but never ships unreviewed - ritual vocabulary, kinship terms and respectful address are exactly where it fails. Content is written for the tradition it serves, not translated word-for-word from the Marathi notes.

Every further language is a gated content pack, earned after families have paid

The content-pack gate - all six required before general sale in a language or region

1
Native reviewer
A named reviewer for templates, preparation notes, ritual and kinship terms.

2
Validation source
Calendar convention(s) confirmed; a reviewed published panchang for that region named and recorded.

3
Golden tests
A fixed date set across years - adhik maas, kshaya and vriddhi, Pitru Paksha - passed for that convention.

4
Regional content
A preparation-content pack written for that tradition, not translated from the Marathi notes.

5
Approved templates
WhatsApp business message templates submitted and approved in that language.

6
Small cohort
A small human-checked cohort from that region, with zero wrong-date incidents.

The order of packs is set by evidence - per-language waitlist sign-ups, referrals from recipients, and requests from families already using the product - not fixed in advance. A language that cannot secure a reviewer and a validation source waits; it does not ship on machine translation.

Members abroad and time zones

- **Compute at home:** dates are always computed at the family home location, using local sunrise there and the family's convention. The observance date is the home-location date.
- **Show it sensibly for the recipient:** a member abroad sees the home-location date and weekday, labelled clearly - for example "Tuesday 9 March - by the family calendar for Pune" - and the message is sent at a sensible local hour in their own time zone. Where the time difference could make the weekday ambiguous, the message names the place the date belongs to.
- **Local observance is a later option:** some diaspora households observe by their own local sunrise. In the pilot this is recorded as a note on the member, not computed separately; whether to support it is an open question.

WhatsApp templates and message cost

- **Template approval per language:** business-initiated WhatsApp messages need pre-approved templates, so each reminder template is submitted and approved separately in each language. Approval is part of every language pack's gate and its lead time.
- **Cost tracked per family:** in the pilot every message is logged per family - count, type, language, recipient country - and costed from the provider's actual billing. The Rs 599 price is then checked against measured cost, not an assumed one. No per-message price is assumed in this document.

MARKET AND COMPETITION - PAN-INDIA

Every region has a trusted almanac. None of them runs a family loop.

The pattern found in Maharashtra repeats across India: a respected regional almanac, large free panchang platforms, regional calendar clones, and national puja platforms. They differ by region; the gap does not.

Competitor	Offering	Price (research)	Fit and limit
Kalnirnay	Maharashtra's almanac institution: print calmanac and app with panchang, festivals, muhurats, event reminders and notes. Print circulation claimed at about 1.82 crore copies in a listing cited in research.	Print / app price could not be verified on a primary page	Trusted household default; self-use and generic dates - not a family's own tithis, no family loop.
Regional almanac brands and calendar apps (pan-India pattern)	Every major language region has its own almanac publishers and calendar apps serving that region's panchang and festivals.	Mostly free with ads; print at low hundreds of rupees per year (varies)	Strong regional trust, same structural limit: individual lookup of generic dates.
Drik Panchang	Full panchang site and app, location-accurate tithi and festival dates; about 4.7 million installs cited in research.	Free (ads)	Excellent data tool in many languages; no family configuration or WhatsApp delivery.
AstroSage	Astrology platform with panchang and festival calendar; very large download claims cited in research.	Free plus paid astrology consultation; comparator consults Rs 10-Rs 80 per minute	Monetises astrology, not family ritual organisation - a model this product explicitly rejects.
Marathi and other regional calendar clones	Year calendar, festival alerts, custom notifications, muhurats, rashifal.	Free (ads)	Undifferentiated, ad-led, churn every January.
Online puja platforms (national)	Book a shraddha or Pitru Paksha puja on the correct tithi, anywhere in India.	Rs 951-Rs 2,001; from Rs 5,100; Rs 7,100 per booking in research examples	Prove families pay around tithi obligations - and must ask the user for the tithi, confirming the record layer is missing.
Substitutes	Printed almanac on the wall; the relative who remembers; Googling festival dates; asking ChatGPT.	Free to low hundreds of rupees	ChatGPT is unreliable for tithi computation - lunar, location-dependent, adhik maas edge cases. The core is deterministic calculation plus a stored family record, so this passes the generic-AI test.

Prices are as published or cited in the October 2026 research report; items the research could not verify on a primary page are labelled as such above.

GAP, DIFFERENTIATORS AND THREATS

The gap is the loop, and the loop is hard to copy from a standing start

Differentiators

- **Tithi correctness:** family dates computed for the home location and convention, checked against a named source. Generic reminder apps and calendars cannot do this; this is the paid core.
- **The family record itself:** once a family has entered and confirmed its occasions, that record is theirs, accurate and hard to recreate elsewhere.
- **WhatsApp delivery to non-app members:** the loop reaches elders and relatives who will never install an app, in their own language.
- **A launch partner with an aligned audience:** MyDharohar brings cross-promotion, shared or licensed festival and preparation content, and early families. That audience is borrowed, not owned - Tithi Loop has to earn its own.
- **Trust positioning:** a named validation source, transparent corrections, and a refusal to sell fear. In a category monetised by anxiety, calm is a differentiator.
- **Region-aware by architecture:** convention, location and tradition are first-class data, so expansion is adding a governed pack.

Threats, stated plainly

- **Kalnirnay or another almanac adds family tithis:** possible, and their trust is deep. Mitigation is speed, the WhatsApp family loop and the MyDharohar partnership. If a trusted almanac launches an equivalent family loop, re-evaluate immediately.
- **Standalone cold start:** a new brand pays more to acquire families and must build its own trust. Mitigated by partner cross-promotion, recipient referrals, gifting, and diaspora and community channels - and measured in the pilot, not assumed.
- **The Rs 0 anchor:** "calendar" and "reminders" mean free in users' minds. Pricing is framed as a family service (pages 18 and 19), never as a paid app.
- **Willingness to pay is unproven:** the money evidence is for print almanacs and pujas - adjacent, not identical. This is exactly what the paid pilot settles before build money is spent.
- **Scope drift into a generic reminders app:** wider occasions bring generic competitors into view. The guardrail is tithi as hero, family-selected festivals only, and the WhatsApp family loop as the product.
- **Accuracy failure:** a single visible wrong shraddha date in a new region could close that region - hence the content-pack gate.

LAUNCH MODEL AND GO-TO-MARKET

A standalone product from day one, with MyDharohar as launch partner

What standalone means (Change 3)

- **Own brand and product:** "Family Tithi Loop" has its own name, configurator app and web, sign-up, billing and WhatsApp Business number. Families sign up with Tithi Loop, and their record is held by Tithi Loop.
- **Own audience over time:** every configurator and every recipient is Tithi Loop's relationship, built through the family loop itself.
- **Boundary:** the family record is private family data. It is not published, not shared beyond invited members, not shared with partners, and not used for astrology or third-party marketing.

MyDharohar as launch partner

Cross-promotion
Introductions to MyDharohar's audience, around festivals and Pitru Paksha, with Tithi Loop clearly named as a partner service.

Shared or licensed content
MyDharohar festival and preparation content, licensed or shared, as the starting preparation library; Marathi/Hindi editorial voice as the template.

Early families
A share of pilot and launch families recruited through MyDharohar - alongside community and diaspora channels.

Future bundle: once standalone pricing is proven, a combined MyDharohar + Tithi Loop plan can be tested as a later phase. It is an option, not a dependency.

Honest trade-offs of a standalone launch

Trade-off	What it means, and the mitigation
Higher acquisition cost	No built-in audience: each family must be found. Mitigation: partner cross-promotion, recipient referrals, gifting, diaspora and community channels; acquisition cost per paying family measured from the pilot.
Its own trust-building	A new brand handling ancestors' dates starts with no reputation. Mitigation: visible correctness (named source, tithi shown in each message), transparent corrections, the partner's endorsement, and calm.
Its own WhatsApp Business setup	Own number, verification, template approvals per language and message billing - to be set up before the pilot, not borrowed.
Its own content	Preparation notes and greetings must be licensed, shared or written, and reviewed per language; partner content reduces but does not remove this work.
Its own sign-up, billing and support	Payments (UPI autopay, cards, USD/CAD), renewals, cancellations and family support are Tithi Loop's to run.

Launched in three languages, grown region by region, bundled later if it helps

Phase	Timing	Scope and channels	Gate to move on
Stage A - Concierge pilot	Nov 2026 - Feb 2027	About 30 families; Marathi, Hindi, English; amanta primary, optional small purnimanta Hindi cohort. MVP occasions: shraddhas, birthdays and anniversaries (tithi or date), vrats and kuldevta days. Run under the Tithi Loop brand and WhatsApp number. Channels: MyDharohar (partner), Marathi and Hindi community groups, mandals, diaspora associations.	Pass bars applied at the decision point, March 2027.
Stage B - Pitru Paksha 2027	Pitru Paksha 2027 (expected September; dates from the validation source) and the festival season after it	Continuing families plus waitlist families. Mahalaya shraddha tithis added; family-selected festivals (for example Ganesh Chaturthi, Diwali, Bhau-beej) and milestones tested as the fast-follow. Still human-checked; if built, the engine runs in shadow.	Zero wrong-date incidents, including Mahalaya tithis, before general sale.
Phase 1 - Standalone paid launch	After Stage B	General sale in the validated languages and conventions, with the free trial as a launch test. Channels: partner cross-promotion, recipient referrals, gifting, diaspora channels, Pitru Paksha and festival campaigns.	Golden tests passed; measured messaging cost fits the price; trial conversion tracked.
Phase 2 - Content packs	Sequenced by demand	Gujarati, Bengali, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, Punjabi, Odia - one pack at a time through the gate on page 11.	Each pack passes its own gate.
Phase 3 - MyDharohar bundle NEW	After standalone pricing is proven	Test a combined MyDharohar + Tithi Loop plan, with its price and revenue share agreed between the two products. A test, not a forecast.	Bundle does not lower standalone conversion or trust.
Phase 4 - Further languages	Later	Any further language (for example Assamese), through the same reviewed-only gate.	Same gate.

Referral is structural: a reminder sent to six family members is also a demonstration to six households, and a forwarded birthday wish reaches one more. Recipients who ask for a language not yet published join a per-language waitlist - the demand evidence that orders the content packs.

Acquisition is the standalone risk to watch: the pilot records where each family came from (partner, community, diaspora, referral), so the launch plan is built on measured channels rather than the partner's audience alone.

MVP SCOPE AND DATA MODEL

The smallest loop that is worth paying for - nothing more

In scope for MVP

- Standalone app/web: sign-up, family record, billing (UPI autopay, card, gift, payer abroad), trial, pause, cancel
- MVP occasions: shraddhas (annual and Mahalaya), birthdays and anniversaries by tithi or date, vrats and kuldevta days
- Region, location and convention selection (validated only)
- Language system architecture: per-language storage, per-member preference, script/transliteration, reviewed-only publishing, fallback, gating flags
- Reviewed content in Marathi, Hindi and English
- Members with language, country, time zone, per-occasion opt-in and frequency cap
- WhatsApp reminders on Tithi Loop's own number, approved templates per language, preparation notes, forwardable wishes
- Read-back and unconfirmed-date flagging
- Priest-ready note, annual family calendar (PDF), record export
- Admin date-check tooling; message and cost log

Fast-follow, then out of scope

- **Fast-follow:** family-selected festivals; life milestones; custom dates; quiet-season digest; "today in our family" memories
- **Later:** MyDharohar bundle; per-household local-sunrise computation for members abroad; voice-call reminders (test separately)
- **Out of scope:** daily panchang, muhurat finder, horoscope or rashifal
- Festival reminders the family did not select
- Native recipient app
- Puja fulfilment (affiliate link only, if at all)
- Content for languages not through the content-pack gate
- Public profiles, social features, family trees

Guardrails that ship with every occasion type

- **Per-occasion opt-in:** each member receives only the occasions they, or the configurator for them, opted into.
- **Per-member frequency cap:** a default cap on reminder messages per member per week (level to be tested), with lower-priority dates held for the digest when the cap is reached.
- **No festival spam:** festivals only if the family selected them. Nothing sent for occasions the family has not chosen.
- **Quiet-season digest:** an optional weekly or monthly digest for minor dates, instead of individual messages; shraddhas are always sent individually.
- **Message cost rises with occasions:** more occasion types mean more messages per family. Caps, digests and per-family cost logging keep this visible; if measured cost outgrows the price, the plan's message allowance or tiering is revisited.

One rule model for every occasion: tithi or Gregorian recurrence

Data model (core entities)

Entity	Key fields
Family	id, name, home location (for sunrise), region, convention, convention status (published / pilot), validation source id, tradition note, plan, trial status, payer, configurator id, acquisition channel
Member	id, family id, name, WhatsApp phone, language (published only), country, time zone, role, opt-in status, frequency cap, digest preference
Person	id, family id, name, relationship, living or ancestor, Gregorian date of passing (optional cross-check), confirmed by
FamilyDate (rule) REPLACES TITHIRULE	id, family id, person ids, occasion type (shraddha / Mahalaya shraddha / birthday / anniversary / festival / vrat-kuldevta / milestone / custom), **recurrence type (tithi / gregorian / festival rule)**; tithi fields (paksha, lunar month, tithi, convention override) or Gregorian fields (day, month, original year); priority (individual / digest); confirmed flag + source; practice note
Mahalaya shraddha NEW	A FamilyDate of type Mahalaya, linked to the ancestor's annual rule and distinct from it: derived tithi (default from death tithi, any month), family-practice override (for example Sarvapitri Amavasya), who confirmed, reviewer-confirmed flag
FestivalRule NEW	Shared, reviewed table: festival name, rule per convention and region, validation source, reviewer. A family links only the festivals it selects.
MemberOptIn NEW	member id, family date id, lead time, individual or digest
Occurrence	id, rule id, year, computed date, tithi at sunrise (if tithi), validation status, edge-case flags
ReminderSchedule	id, occurrence id, member id, lead time, language, local send time, cap/digest decision, send status, receipt
ContentNote	id, occasion type, region/tradition, language, kind (preparation / wish / memory), reviewer, published flag, source (own / licensed / partner-shared), text
Memory NEW	id, family date id, year, short text, opt-in flag ("today in our family")
MessageLog NEW	id, family id, member id, template id, language, recipient country, sent at, delivery status, billed cost (from provider)

Why one rule model: the same record handles a shraddha by tithi, a birthday by date and a family-selected festival by rule, so adding occasion types is configuration, not new engineering. Only tithi and festival rules go through the correctness system; Gregorian dates are simple recurrences.

PRICING AND BUSINESS MODEL

Priced as a family service, because that is what it is

Price test: Rs 599 per year per family for the standalone plan - about Rs 50 a month. Framing range for testing: Rs 499-Rs 999. Pilot season: Rs 299, a founding-family price. Future option: a combined MyDharohar + Tithi Loop plan. All figures are proposals to validate - not forecasts of revenue or willingness to pay.

Free trial at launch - a test to run at launch, not in the pilot: the trial lasts until the family's first reminder is delivered or 30 days, whichever is later - because family dates are sparse and a plain 30-day window could show no value. A payment method is collected at sign-up (UPI autopay or card) so the plan converts automatically, with a reminder before the first charge and cancellation in one step. **Trial conversion rate is a launch metric.** The pilot stays paid at Rs 299 upfront, because a free trial would not test willingness to pay.

- **Per family, not per user:** one plan covers the configurator and all invited recipients. Per-user pricing would punish inviting the whole family and price elders as seats.
- **What the plan pays for:** every family occasion in one place, with tithi dates checked and converted every year; reminders to everyone, in their language; wishes, preparation notes and the annual family calendar; and a recurring worry taken off one person's shoulders.
- **Bundle later:** a MyDharohar combined plan is tested only after standalone pricing is proven, so the bundle cannot hide whether families value Tithi Loop on its own.

Upsells and paid extras - allowed and forbidden

Allowed (optional, non-exploitative)

- Puja-booking affiliate, with the relationship disclosed.
- Printed family calendar, offered once a year.
- Larger-family tier near Rs 999 per year (a test).

Forbidden

- Fear-based astrology, dosha warnings or paid remedies.
- Urgency or guilt messaging around a death observance.
- Selling family data or targeting third-party offers.
- Holding the family record hostage - export is always free.

Costs to watch

WhatsApp message cost - which rises as families add occasions - measured per family from actual billing and held in check by caps and digests; Tithi Loop's own WhatsApp Business setup and template approvals per language; acquisition cost per paying family for a standalone brand; content licensing or writing; editorial cost for three pilot languages, with each further pack approved only after the pass bars; and human date-checking in the pilot. The plan must cover messaging for a typical family with headroom; the pilot's measured cost sets that assumption before launch pricing is fixed.

WHY FAMILIES WILL PAY NEW

A family service people are glad to pay for - sold calmly, with no fear

Families will not pay for a calendar. They may pay to be relieved of a worry. The offer is built around four things the pilot will test. All prices on these pages are tests; no market figures are assumed.

1

The one who remembers can stop

In most families one person carries every tithi, birthday and anniversary and converts the tithis each year. The pitch: "you no longer have to be the one who remembers for everyone".

2

The family member abroad is included

Members abroad often learn of a shraddha or a parent's tithi birthday after it has passed. The Loop tells them in time, with the date shown clearly for where they live.

3

Peace of mind about the date

Tithi dates are computed for the home location and convention, checked against a named source, and show the tithi used - so a priest or elder can verify them.

4

The family's heritage is kept

The record of ancestors, occasions and milestones is preserved, private and exportable - something families fear losing when an elder is gone.

What the family plan includes

Feature	What the family gets
Every occasion, tithi-aware	Shraddhas (annual and Mahalaya), birthdays and anniversaries by tithi or date, vrats and kuldevta days - then family-selected festivals, milestones and custom dates
Whole-family reminders	Every invited member, in their language, at their lead time, with per-occasion opt-in and a frequency cap
Checked dates	Every tithi date checked against a named source; shraddhas re-checked before sending
Forwardable wishes	A short wish for birthdays and anniversaries that the recipient can forward to the person being celebrated
Annual family calendar	The year's family dates in one message and a PDF calendar to share; printed copy as an optional add-on
Today in our family	Optional gentle memories on milestone anniversaries - only for occasions the family opted in
Priest-ready note	Person, relationship, tithi, paksha, month, convention and this year's date, ready to forward
Family record export	PDF and spreadsheet - the family's to keep, even if they stop paying

All features are views of the record the family already keeps, so they are cheap to deliver - though each extra message has a cost, which is logged. None involves astrology, predictions, dosha warnings or urgency messaging.

WHY FAMILIES WILL PAY, CONTINUED NEW

Present the price simply, ask at the moment of value, and let recipients spread it

Ways to buy

- **Gift a plan to parents:** an adult child buys and sets up the plan; parents receive a warm invite naming the giver.
- **Diaspora plan:** a member abroad pays in USD or CAD, with the home family as recipients.
- **Larger-family tier:** for big or multi-household families.

Pricing presentation - all tests

Offer	Test price	How it is presented
Family plan	Rs 599 per year per family	"About Rs 50 a month for the whole family."
Free trial (launch)	Free until the first reminder is delivered or 30 days, whichever is later	Payment method at sign-up (UPI autopay or card); reminder before the first charge; cancel in one step. Not offered in the pilot.
Founding family	Rs 299 for the pilot season, upfront	A founding price locked in for the first full year after the pilot (level to be tested; the Rs 599 intent question is still asked).
Larger-family tier	Near Rs 999 per year	Tests the top of the Rs 499-Rs 999 range.
Payer abroad	USD and CAD prices, to be set	Shown in the payer's currency; not derived from any market figure.
MyDharohar bundle (later)	To be set	A combined plan, tested only after standalone pricing is proven.

Conversion tactics

Pilot: show the dates, then ask
No free reminder in the pilot. The family sees the read-back of its own dates for this year, then pays Rs 299 before any reminder is sent - so the payment bar measures real payment.

Launch: trial that reaches a real reminder
The trial runs until the first reminder lands, so every family experiences value before the first charge. Trial conversion rate is tracked as a launch metric.

Referral through recipients
A quiet closing line - "Set this up for your own family" - and forwarded wishes. Nothing pushy around a death observance.

Seasonal campaigns
Calm, content-led campaigns with the partner before Pitru Paksha 2027 ("Record every ancestor's Mahalaya tithi") and the festival season. The annual calendar doubles as the renewal moment.

A calm sales conversation: name the burden, show the dates, ask once

The pilot is sold person to person, by call or WhatsApp. The script is short, never mentions fear or consequences, and asks once - after the family has seen its own dates.

Pilot sales script (call or WhatsApp)

1. "Namaskar - I'm from Family Tithi Loop, a new service launching with MyDharohar as our partner. We're running a small pilot with about 30 families."
2. "In most families, one person remembers everyone's shraddha tithis, birthdays and anniversaries and works out the tithi dates each year. Is that someone in your family?" (Let them answer.)
3. "You tell us your family's occasions once - by tithi or by date. Each year we work out the right dates for your home town and tradition, a person checks them, and everyone you choose gets a WhatsApp reminder a week before and two days before - in Marathi, Hindi or English."
4. "Nobody needs to install anything. If someone lives abroad, they see the date clearly for where they are."
5. "First we'll send you this year's dates for your family to check. The pilot season, November to February, is Rs 299 for the whole family, paid before reminders start - a founding-family price. Shall we begin with your family's dates?"

Objection handling

Objection	Calm answer
"Calendars are free."	"They are, and we don't replace them. A calendar doesn't know your grandfather's shraddha tithi, work out this year's date, or tell your brother in Canada. That is what we do - for the whole family, for about Rs 50 a month."
"I'll just remember."	"You probably do - for everyone. This takes it off your shoulders, so the dates are safe when you're travelling, busy, or when the next generation takes over. And you keep the record."
"Is it accurate?"	"Every tithi date is calculated for your home location and tradition and checked by a person against a named panchang before it is sent. Each message shows the tithi, so your priest can check it. If we ever find a mistake, we tell you directly."
"Why pay before we try it?"	"You'll see all your family's dates for this year, worked out and checked, before you pay. This is a small paid pilot; when we launch, new families get a free trial, and founding families keep a founding price."
"Who are you? I know MyDharohar."	"We're a separate service; MyDharohar is our launch partner. Your family's record stays with us and is never shared."
"I don't want lots of messages."	"Only the occasions you choose, with a weekly limit, and a digest if you prefer. Anyone can reply STOP or PAUSE."
"Our custom is different."	"We record your family's practice - we don't decide religious questions."

What the sales conversation must never do: warn of consequences for a missed shraddha, imply astrological risk, or create urgency around a death observance. If a family says no, thank them and offer the launch waitlist. Calm is the brand.

VALIDATION BEFORE BUILDING - CHANGE 6 IN DEPTH

Thirty families, two stages, no engine - then decide

The pilot tests what no research can settle: whether the reminders are valued across a whole family, and whether anyone pays a new, standalone brand. It uses human effort instead of software, so the decision is made before build cost is sunk. Pitru Paksha 2026 has passed, so the pilot starts now and keeps Pitru Paksha 2027 as its second stage.

Pilot design

1. **Recruit about 30 families, concentrated:** mostly Maharashtra-rooted amanta families using Marathi, Hindi or English, plus an optional purnimanta Hindi cohort of about 5-6 families. Prioritise families with a shraddha between November 2026 and February 2027, members in more than one city, and a member abroad. Recruit through MyDharohar (partner) and Marathi and Hindi community channels, mandals and diaspora associations, recording each family's channel.
2. **Intake by form** (Appendix A): ancestors, birthdays and anniversaries by tithi or date, vrats, selected festivals and milestones, members with languages, countries, time zones and frequency preferences. Uncertain tithis get a guided call and are flagged unconfirmed.
3. **Semi-manual computation:** every tithi date checked by a person against the named validation source; shraddhas re-checked before sending.
4. **WhatsApp reminders by hand** from Tithi Loop's own WhatsApp Business number, in each member's language, within frequency caps. Every message logged and costed per family.
5. **Two stages: Stage A**, November 2026 - February 2027 - MVP occasions: shraddhas, birthdays and anniversaries, vrats and kuldevta days. **Stage B**, Pitru Paksha 2027 and the festival season after it - Mahalaya shraddha tithis, plus family-selected festivals and milestones as the fast-follow test.
6. **Charge for it, upfront:** Rs 299 for the Stage A season, paid after the family has checked its read-back and before any reminder is sent. No free reminder and no free trial in the pilot: a free pilot or trial would measure politeness, not willingness to pay. The free trial is a launch test.
7. **Interview** configurators and recipients separately, including an elder and a member abroad, about usefulness and message frequency. The Rs 599 question is asked after the family has experienced the reminders.

> **Pass bars (unchanged; all required to build):** at least 15 of 30 families pay Rs 299 for the season; at least 10 say, after experiencing it, that they would pay Rs 599 per year; zero wrong-date incidents; and recipients - not only configurators - report the reminders were useful and welcome.

When the bars are applied: payment, intent and usefulness at the end of Stage A (March 2027). Zero wrong dates applies to every date in both stages; a wrong date in Stage B blocks general sale.

> **If it fails on payment but succeeds on love:** families value the reminders but will not pay for a standalone product - offer the Loop as a feature bundled into MyDharohar rather than a standalone business, in line with the research verdict. If it fails on usefulness, stop. If a date error occurs, fix the process and re-run the affected check before any build decision.

A gated roadmap: each phase is earned by the previous one

Phase	Timing	Work and gate
Prepare pilot	Now - mid-November 2026	Tithi Loop's own WhatsApp Business number, simple sign-up page and payment link; partnership terms with MyDharohar (cross-promotion, content, early families); intake form; validation source and reviewers; templates in three languages; recruitment.
Stage A pilot	Nov 2026 - Feb 2027	Run the paid concierge pilot; log every date check, message and acquisition channel; collect Rs 299 payments and Rs 599 intent answers.
Decision point	March 2027	Apply the pass bars on page 22 without moving them. Build standalone, offer as a MyDharohar bundled feature, or stop.
If build: MVP	From March 2027	Standalone app/web with sign-up, billing and trial; engine with golden tests per convention; MVP occasions; language system; guardrails; content in three languages.
Stage B pilot	Pitru Paksha 2027	Human-checked Mahalaya run and festival/milestone fast-follow; engine in shadow. Gate: zero wrong-date incidents.
Standalone launch	After Stage B	General sale with the free trial as a launch test; trial conversion rate and acquisition cost per paying family tracked.
Content packs; bundle	By demand; later	Language packs through the gate on page 11; MyDharohar combined plan tested once standalone pricing is proven.

Principal risks

- **Date error** - highest severity; mitigations on pages 8-9 and the two-stage pilot.
- **Low willingness to pay** - settled by the paid Stage A before build spend.
- **Standalone acquisition cost and trust** - partner cross-promotion, referrals, community and diaspora channels; channels measured in the pilot.
- **Message cost rising with occasions** - caps, digests and per-family cost logging; revisit allowance or tiering if cost outgrows the price.
- **WhatsApp policy, template approval or cost changes** - keep the family record exportable and not tied to one messaging provider.
- **Scope drift** into a generic reminders app or a panchang app - every request is tested against Change 1.
- **Tradition disputes and Mahalaya rules** - the family's practice is recorded, not adjudicated; rules confirmed with each convention's reviewer.

Kill and pivot criteria

- **Kill:** families do not find reminders useful, or a correctness process cannot be made reliable at pilot scale.
- **Pivot to a bundled feature:** loved but not paid for as a standalone product (page 22).
- **Pause a content pack:** where a reviewer, validation source or template approval cannot be secured.

OPEN QUESTIONS AND NEXT STEPS

What is still undecided - and what happens next

Open questions for the pilot to answer

- What lead times and message frequency do families want, and when does a digest work better?
- How many members and occasions does a paying family add, and what is the measured message cost per family per year inside Rs 599?
- Which channels bring paying families to a standalone brand, and at what effort?
- Which festivals and milestones do families choose, and do they value forwardable wishes and memories?
- How often is an input tithi uncertain, and what resolves it fastest?
- Who pays in families with members abroad, and does a USD/CAD price or gifting change conversion?
- At launch: what is the trial conversion rate?
- Does the name still fit the wider scope?

Next steps, in order

1. **This week:** confirm the Stage A window (November 2026 - February 2027) and Stage B (Pitru Paksha 2027, dates from the validation source).
2. **By early November:** agree partner terms with MyDharohar (cross-promotion, shared or licensed content, early-family introductions); name the amanta validation source and a reviewer each for Marathi, Hindi and English; build the date-check sheet and message/cost log.
3. **By mid-November:** set up Tithi Loop's own WhatsApp Business number and submit templates per language; a simple sign-up page and payment link; finalise the intake form (Appendix A, page 25; Google Forms version, Appendix B, page 29); set the USD/CAD and founding-family prices.
4. **November:** recruit about 30 families through MyDharohar and community and diaspora channels; send each family its read-back, then collect Rs 299 upfront before any reminder.
5. **November - February:** run, log and interview. **March 2027:** decide by the pass bars, not by enthusiasm.
6. **Before Pitru Paksha 2027:** confirm Mahalaya and festival rules with reviewers; run the seasonal campaign and Stage B.

Sources and basis

Market, competitor, pricing and verdict basis: market research report, "Four New App Ideas + Fresh Ideation - Market and Competitor Research (India-first)", 22 October 2026, section B2 (Family Tithi Loop deep dive). Competitor prices and scale figures are as reported there, with unverifiable items labelled. Proposed prices (Rs 299 pilot season; Rs 599 per year, within a Rs 499-Rs 999 test range; a tier near Rs 999; USD/CAD and bundle prices to be set), the free-trial design, lead times, caps, phase sequencing and language-pack order are proposals to be validated. No WhatsApp message prices are assumed. MyDharohar live site: https://www.mydharohar.org/

> **Recommendation:** approve the pilot, not the product - paid, standalone-branded, in three languages. It tests payment, usefulness, acquisition and correctness at once, and its result - build standalone, offer as a MyDharohar bundled feature, or stop - will be clear enough to act on.

Family Tithi Loop - pilot intake form (Stage A, November 2026 - February 2027)

> **Language note:** this form is in English. Marathi and Hindi versions are needed for the pilot and must be translated and reviewed by a named native reviewer before use - especially ritual terms (tithi, paksha, shraddha, Mahalaya), kinship terms and respectful address. Machine translation may assist a draft; it must not be used unreviewed.

Thank you for joining the Family Tithi Loop pilot (launching with MyDharohar as our partner). You tell us your family's occasions once - shraddhas, birthdays, anniversaries, the vrats and festivals you keep, milestones - by tithi or by date. We work out each date for this year for your home location and tradition, have a person check the tithi dates, and send WhatsApp reminders to the family members you choose, each in their own language.

This takes about 15-20 minutes. If you are unsure of any tithi, fill in what you know and mark it "not sure" - we will help you confirm it on a short call. Nothing is sent until you have reviewed and confirmed your family's dates.

Section 1 - About you (the configurator)

Your full name	
Your WhatsApp number with country code, e.g. +91 98xxxxxxxx	
Email optional	
Your preferred language for messages from us	☐ Marathi ☐ Hindi ☐ English
How did you hear about the pilot?	☐ MyDharohar (partner) ☐ Family or friend ☐ Community or mandal group ☐ Diaspora association ☐ Other

Section 2 - Family home location and tradition

Family name as you would like it shown	
Family home location used for dates town/city, district, state - the place whose sunrise the family follows	
Second household location optional, for information only; dates are computed for the home location	
Calendar convention your family follows	☐ Amanta (month ends on Amavasya - common in Maharashtra, Gujarat and the south) ☐ Purnimanta (month ends on Purnima - common in much of north India) ☐ Not sure - please help us confirm
Community, tradition or family practice notes optional - e.g. kuldevta, family priest's guidance, a known family custom	
Who do you usually consult on tithis? optional	☐ Family priest ☐ An elder ☐ Printed almanac (name) ☐ Online panchang ☐ Other

Your family's occasions: ancestors, birthdays, anniversaries and other dates

Section 3 - Ancestors (shraddha)

Add one row for each ancestor whose shraddha your family observes. If you know the tithi, enter paksha, lunar month and tithi. If you know only the Gregorian date of passing, enter that - we will convert it and mark it "unconfirmed" until your family checks it.

Name	Relationship to you	Paksha (Shukla / Krishna / not sure)	Lunar month	Tithi	OR Gregorian date of passing (+ place)	Confirmed? (Yes / Unconfirmed)	Who confirmed (elder, priest, almanac)	Mahalaya practice (same tithi / Sarvapitri Amavasya / other / not sure)
Vasant Joshi	*Grandfather (Ajoba)*	*Krishna*	*Magha*	*Saptami*	*-*	*Yes*	*Aaji*	*Same tithi*

Mahalaya note: the shraddha during Pitru Paksha is recorded separately from the annual death-anniversary shraddha. We use it for Pitru Paksha 2027 (Stage B). If your family follows a different custom, tell us - we record your practice, we do not decide it.

Section 4 - Birthdays, anniversaries and other family dates

Add birthdays, wedding anniversaries, death anniversaries kept by date, milestones (munj/upanayan, naming ceremony, griha pravesh) and any custom date. For each, tell us whether your family keeps it by **tithi** or by **calendar date**.

Occasion (birthday / anniversary / death anniversary / milestone / custom)	Person(s)	Relationship	Kept by (tithi / calendar date / both)	If tithi: paksha, month, tithi	If date: day, month (year)	Confirmed? (Yes / Unconfirmed)	Notes
Birthday	*Aaji*	*Grandmother*	*Tithi*	*Shukla, Shravana, Panchami*	*-*	*Yes*	

Your vrats and festivals, and who should be reminded

Section 5 - Vrats, kuldevta days and festivals your family keeps

Only the ones your family actually observes. We never send festival reminders you have not chosen.

Vrats and kuldevta days

☐ Ekadashi (both) ☐ Ekadashi (selected) ☐ Sankashti Chaturthi ☐ Angarki Sankashti
☐ Satyanarayan puja ☐ Kuldevta day ☐ Pradosh ☐ Purnima ☐ Other family-specific vrat

Festivals

☐ Diwali / Lakshmi Puja ☐ Ganesh Chaturthi ☐ Raksha Bandhan ☐ Bhau-beej / Bhai Dooj
☐ Karva Chauth ☐ Makar Sankranti ☐ Gudi Padwa ☐ Navratri ☐ Dussehra ☐ Janmashtami
☐ Maha Shivratri ☐ Other

Observance or festival	Details - which ones, any family rule	Who observes it

Section 6 - Family members to remind

Add each person who should receive reminders. They will get a WhatsApp invite naming you and can decline or stop at any time. Please only add people you have told about the pilot.

Name	Relationship	WhatsApp number (with country code)	Language (Marathi / Hindi / English)	Which observances (all / shraddha / vrats / list)	Lead time (7+2 days / 7 / 2 / other)	Day-of note? / Digest for minor dates? (Y/N)	Country	City / time zone
Sunita	*Daughter*	*+1 416 xxx xxxx*	*English*	*All*	*7 + 2 days*	*N / Y*	*Canada*	*Toronto*

Members abroad: dates are worked out for the family home location. Members abroad see that date and weekday, labelled with the home location, and messages arrive at a sensible local hour. Each member receives only the occasions ticked for them, within a weekly limit.

Consent, payment and privacy

Section 7 - Consent and opt-in

☐ I confirm the family members listed have agreed to be added, or I will tell them before their invite is sent.

☐ I agree that Family Tithi Loop may send WhatsApp messages about my family's listed dates to me and to the members listed, from the Family Tithi Loop pilot WhatsApp number.

☐ I understand any member can reply STOP to stop or PAUSE to pause, at any time, and I will be told gently if someone opts out.

☐ I agree to a short call or messages from the pilot team to confirm dates and to give feedback during and after the pilot.

> **Suggested invite wording for members:** "Namaskar - [configurator name] has added you to your family's date reminders from Family Tithi Loop. You will receive WhatsApp reminders only for the family occasions chosen for you, in [language]. Reply YES to receive them, or STOP if you would rather not."

Section 8 - Pilot payment acknowledgement

☐ I understand the pilot season (November 2026 - February 2027) costs **Rs 299 for the whole family** - a founding-family price. It is paid upfront, after I have checked the read-back of my family's dates and before any reminder is sent. There is no free trial in the pilot.

Payment details (UPI or link) are sent separately on WhatsApp after your dates are confirmed. The Rs 299 pilot price is a test price.

Section 9 - Privacy

- Your family record (names, relationships, tithis, phone numbers) is private family data, used only to compute dates and send reminders to the people you have invited.
- It is not published, not shared with anyone outside your invited members and the small pilot team, not used for astrology, and not used for third-party marketing or sold.
- Family Tithi Loop holds your record. MyDharohar is our launch partner but does not receive your family record.
- Every date is checked by a person on the pilot team against a named panchang source. Only this team sees your record.
- You can ask for a copy of your family record, or ask us to delete it, at any time by replying on WhatsApp or emailing the pilot team.
- If we ever find a date was wrong, we will tell you directly, before the observance wherever possible.

☐ I have read the privacy note and agree.

Name	
Date	

APPENDIX B - GOOGLE FORMS QUESTION LIST

The intake form, ready to build in Google Forms

How to set it up: paste section by section into Google Forms, using "Add section" for each section below. For repeating items (ancestors, birthdays, members), create five repeated sub-sections (for example "Ancestor 1" ... "Ancestor 5"), each ending with "Add another?" and using "Go to section based on answer". Alternatively, collect repeating details in a linked Google Sheet during the guided call. Put the privacy note (Appendix A, Section 9) in the section description. Marathi and Hindi forms need native review before use.

#	Section	Question	Type	Options / validation	Required
1	**1 About you**	Your full name	Short answer		Yes
2	**1 About you**	Your WhatsApp number (with country code)	Short answer	Validation: regex ^\+[0-9]{8,16}$	Yes
3	**1 About you**	Email	Short answer	Validation: email	No
4	**1 About you**	Your preferred language for messages from us	Multiple choice	Marathi; Hindi; English	Yes
5	**1 About you**	How did you hear about the pilot?	Multiple choice	MyDharohar (partner); Family or friend; Community or mandal group; Diaspora association; Other	No
6	**2 Home and tradition**	Family name	Short answer		Yes
7	**2 Home and tradition**	Family home location used for dates (town/city, district, state)	Short answer	Help text: the place whose sunrise your family follows	Yes
8	**2 Home and tradition**	Second household location (for information)	Short answer		No
9	**2 Home and tradition**	Calendar convention your family follows	Multiple choice	Amanta; Purnimanta; Not sure - please help us confirm	Yes
10	**2 Home and tradition**	Community, tradition or family practice notes	Paragraph		No
11	**2 Home and tradition**	Who do you usually consult on tithis?	Checkboxes	Family priest; An elder; Printed almanac; Online panchang; Other	No
12	**3 Ancestor N**	Ancestor name	Short answer		Yes
13	**3 Ancestor N**	Relationship to you	Short answer		Yes
14	**3 Ancestor N**	Do you know the tithi of passing?	Multiple choice	Yes - I know the tithi; No - I know the Gregorian date; Not sure of either	Yes

Ancestors, family dates, vrats and festivals

#	Section	Question	Type	Options / validation	Required
15	**3 Ancestor N**	Paksha	Multiple choice	Shukla; Krishna; Not sure	No
16	**3 Ancestor N**	Lunar month	Dropdown	Chaitra; Vaishakha; Jyeshtha; Ashadha; Shravana; Bhadrapada; Ashwin; Kartik; Margashirsha; Pausha; Magha; Phalguna; Adhik (extra) month; Not sure	No
17	**3 Ancestor N**	Tithi	Dropdown	Pratipada; Dwitiya; Tritiya; Chaturthi; Panchami; Shashthi; Saptami; Ashtami; Navami; Dashami; Ekadashi; Dwadashi; Trayodashi; Chaturdashi; Purnima; Amavasya; Not sure	No
18	**3 Ancestor N**	Gregorian date of passing (marked unconfirmed until checked)	Date		No
19	**3 Ancestor N**	Place of passing (if known)	Short answer		No
20	**3 Ancestor N**	Has this tithi been confirmed?	Multiple choice	Yes; No - unconfirmed	Yes
21	**3 Ancestor N**	Who confirmed it?	Short answer	e.g. Aaji, family priest, almanac	No
22	**3 Ancestor N**	Pitru Paksha (Mahalaya) shraddha practice	Multiple choice	Same tithi in Pitru Paksha; Sarvapitri Amavasya; Other family custom; Not sure	No
23	**3 Ancestor N**	Add another ancestor?	Multiple choice	Yes (next ancestor); No (go to section 4)	Yes
24	**4 Date N**	Occasion type	Multiple choice	Birthday; Wedding anniversary; Death anniversary (by date); Milestone (munj/upanayan, naming, griha pravesh); Custom	Yes
25	**4 Date N**	Person(s) and relationship	Short answer		Yes
26	**4 Date N**	Kept by	Multiple choice	Tithi; Calendar date; Both	Yes
27	**4 Date N**	If tithi: paksha, lunar month, tithi; if date: the date (and year); confirmed?	Dropdown / Date / Multiple choice	Same option lists as section 3	No
28	**4 Date N**	Add another date?	Multiple choice	Yes; No (go to section 5)	Yes
29	**5 Vrats and festivals**	Which festivals does your family observe?	Checkboxes	Diwali / Lakshmi Puja; Ganesh Chaturthi; Raksha Bandhan; Bhau-beej / Bhai Dooj; Karva Chauth; Makar Sankranti; Gudi Padwa; Navratri; Dussehra; Janmashtami; Maha Shivratri; Other	No
30	**5 Vrats and festivals**	Which vrats and kuldevta days does your family keep?	Checkboxes	Ekadashi (both); Ekadashi (selected); Sankashti Chaturthi; Angarki Sankashti; Satyanarayan puja; Kuldevta day; Pradosh; Purnima; Other	No
31	**5 Vrats**	Details: which ones, which month, any family rule, who observes	Paragraph		No

Members, consent, payment and privacy

#	Section	Question	Type	Options / validation	Required
32	**6 Member N**	Member name	Short answer		Yes
33	**6 Member N**	Relationship	Short answer		Yes
34	**6 Member N**	WhatsApp number (with country code)	Short answer	Validation: regex ^\+[0-9]{8,16}$	Yes
35	**6 Member N**	Language for reminders	Multiple choice	Marathi; Hindi; English	Yes
36	**6 Member N**	Which observances should they receive?	Checkboxes	All; Shraddha (annual); Mahalaya shraddha (Pitru Paksha 2027); Birthdays by tithi; Vrats	Yes
37	**6 Member N**	Reminder lead time	Multiple choice	7 days and 2 days before (suggested); 7 days only; 2 days only; Other	Yes
38	**6 Member N**	Also send a short note on the day?	Multiple choice	Yes; No	Yes
39	**6 Member N**	Minor dates as a digest instead of individual messages?	Multiple choice	Individual messages; Weekly digest; Monthly digest	No
40	**6 Member N**	Country where they live	Dropdown	India; USA; Canada; UK; UAE; Australia; Singapore; Other	Yes
41	**6 Member N**	City / time zone	Short answer	e.g. Toronto, Pune	Yes
42	**6 Member N**	Add another member?	Multiple choice	Yes; No	Yes
43	**7 Consent**	Consent statements (the four in Section 7)	Checkboxes	One option per statement; all required	Yes (all)
44	**8 Payment**	Pilot payment acknowledgement (Rs 299 founding-family season price, paid upfront after the read-back; no free trial in the pilot)	Checkboxes	I understand and agree	Yes
45	**9 Privacy**	I have read the privacy note and agree	Checkboxes	I agree (privacy note in section description)	Yes
46	**9 Privacy**	Anything else we should know?	Paragraph		No

After submission (pilot team): enter responses into the date-check sheet; flag every unconfirmed tithi and every "not sure" convention for the guided call; compute dates and check each against the named validation source; send the read-back to the configurator for confirmation before any reminder is scheduled; log every message and its billed cost per family.